



Delaware County Council Meeting August 25th 2020

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VwC9-4niE6c
Publication Date	2020-08-25T16:29:36Z
Target Category	delaware_county

Notice: This report is provided by the [Muncie Policy Memo](#) as a public service. This summary is generated automatically using artificial intelligence from public video transcripts, both of which are prone to error. The report is intended to provide an overview of meeting business and an aid to accessing detailed information from the video recording. When accuracy is critical, please refer to the official video recording or approved minutes.

Delaware County Council Meeting Report

Meeting Date: August 25, 2020

Body: Delaware County Council

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer opened the Delaware County Council meeting of August 25, 2020, noting ongoing pandemic restrictions and providing public email instructions for public comments (county_councildist@co.delaware.in.us).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. Ballard, Mr. Bledsoe, Ms. Chambers, Ms. Lasseter, Ms. Piper, Mr. Quakenbush, Mr. Alexander, Mr. Hughes.
 - **Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Mr. Alexander (implied by leadership of proceedings).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The council stood for the Pledge of Allegiance led by Steve [00:00:31](#).

- **Approval of Minutes:** Minutes from the July 28 meeting were approved via roll call vote (Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call recorded unanimously).
 - **Agenda Approval:** Agenda approved via roll call vote.
-

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:03:19 County Clerk Transfer Request**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Clerk (Rick).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer within Clerk budget to adjust part-time and office supplies totaling a net-zero request (\$59,994.50 adjustments). Clerk discussed preparations for a projected 15,000 to 20,000 absentee ballots for the fall election (compared to 7,000 in the spring).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:11:11 EMS A101 Executive Director Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** EMS / Department representative.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reallocation of executive director line items for a net-zero request of \$3,076.92.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:06:55 Public Defender Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Public Defender Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Net-zero transfer moving \$1,000 into line 211, offset by reductions in lines 184 and 323.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:07:35 Sheriff Department Transfer (B 135 / B 101)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sheriff / Presiding Officer.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The presiding officer noted that after speaking with the sheriff that morning, this item was **withdrawn** from the agenda to allow further review of the contract.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Withdrawn / Pulled from agenda.
- **00:08:38 Communication Center Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Communication Center representative.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfers moving funds into overtime and holiday pay to cover severe staffing shortages (dispatcher departures to fire, EMS, and military) and heavy overtime use (~\$7,000 in the last pay period). Net request: \$0.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call (Passed Unanimously).

- **00:09:59 911 Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** 911 / Communications.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Net-zero transfer moving funds from insurance and educational incentives into holiday pay (\$7,000).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:12:53 County Commissioners Addendum: ADA Assistant to Veteran Affairs (VA) Assistant**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Donna / Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Net-zero transfer of \$10,476.56 from ADA Assistant to VA Assistant.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:13:37 Clerk Election Supply Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Clerk Rick.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$20,000 from precinct workers to office supplies specifically for state-mandated absentee ballot mailing and return envelopes. Extensive discussion regarding CARES Act reimbursement eligibility, postage costs hitting the commissioners' budget, and poll worker recruitment.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:23:31 Public Defender Transfer (C 164 / D 164)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Public Defender Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Net-zero transfer of \$10,500 between public defender lines.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:24:14 Jail Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jail Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Net-zero adjustments across jail operating accounts.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:25:00 Sheriff Department Transfer (Gasoline to Contracts)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sheriff Department / Council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$30,371 from gasoline (due to lower fuel costs) to contracts (covering cell phone extraction software for investigators, Leads Online, and increased mobile wi-fi/cell data costs).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:27:35 Financial Agenda: Public Defender Court-Ordered Attorneys**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Shelley Harvey (Office Administrator) / Kelly Brian (Chief Public Defender).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Request for additional appropriation for court-ordered/hourly contract attorneys (particularly driven by juvenile court and CHINS cases requiring multiple conflict-free counsel). Initially requested \$30,000, reduced by finance committee to \$30,000, and further debated regarding budget deficit impacts. Council and public defenders discussed a proposal to transition a part-time public defender to full-time starting October 1st to mitigate outsourcing costs and secure state reimbursement.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition: Amended and Approved.** Motion to amend request from \$30,000 to **\$22,000** to limit general fund drawdowns affecting future budget cuts. Approved by Roll Call (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:17:21 EMS Education Incentive Pay Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mike Ashley (EMS).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$2,769.12 for education incentive pay for three additional personnel moving up in class.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:59:14 Cumulative Building Fund: Badges and Key Fobs**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Building / Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request of \$1,030 for badges and key fobs.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:59:53 Local Road and Street: Road Signs & Striping**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Highway / Transportation.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$60,000 (supplementing existing budget funds) for road striping covering over 50 miles of roads and 20 railroad crossing markings.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call (Passed Unanimously).
- **01:02:05 Health Department Immunization Grant Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Health Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Grant appropriation totaling \$38,570 (part-time, FICA, supplies, clinic supplies, travel, other operating).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call (Passed Unanimously).
- **01:03:29 Omnibus Motion: Transfers, Financial Addendum & Hiring Freeze Compliance**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Motion to approve all transfers, the financial addendum, amend the salary ordinance with hiring freeze reductions, and ensure compliance with Resolution 20-2015.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call (Passed Unanimously).
 - **01:04:14 Maximum Levies and Tax Caps Review**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Donna (Auditor).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Annual mandatory review of maximum levies and tax caps for all local taxing units. Following past practice, a motion was made to issue **no recommendation** regarding maximum levies and tax caps.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call (Passed Unanimously).
-

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(Note: No members of the public addressed the council during an open public forum; however, council members discussed broader community and tax policy items.) - **01:08:28 Council Member Steve:** Expressed concern over reported discussions by the city regarding potential local income tax (LIT) increases during difficult economic times; commissioners and council members echoed agreement opposing tax increases during the pandemic. - **01:09:32 Donna (Auditor):** Emphasized the importance of census participation for Muncie to maintain voting leverage on LIT decisions.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Budget Hearings Schedule:** Scheduled for September 1st, 2nd, and 3rd, 2020. The schedule was inverted to place larger departments first to manage time effectively.
 - **Auditor's Revenue Report:** Auditor Donna reported severe impending revenue shortfalls for the upcoming budget year, projecting an 8.254 million dollar cut requirement due to revenue losses in riverboat wagering, EMS billing, city reimbursements, interest earnings (\$350k loss), LIT taxes, and rising circuit breaker impacts.
 - **Adjournment:** Meeting adjourned following final housekeeping motions.
-

Muncie Policy Memo Civic Monitoring Automated Pipeline. Report generated on 2026-10-04 04:55:05 using model gemini-3.5-flash-lite.